



YOU ARE **22 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**
125 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This is a landmark week for your baby's senses: hearing and balance, both controlled by the inner ear, start to mature now. As this image shows, the ears are still not in their final position at the side of the head.

“If your emotions are all over the place, try having a good cry, preferably on someone's shoulder. You'll feel a whole lot better.”

It's normal to feel a bit up and down emotionally. The best way to manage is to give yourself some time out and the low points will soon pass. If you find yourself crying at a commercial yet again, try to see the funny side! Sharing this fact with someone else may also help, especially a pregnant friend or new mom—she more than anyone else will be able to relate to how you're feeling and reassure you.

However, be aware that depression can develop or recur in pregnancy. If the sad feelings persist, you have a history of depression, you are starting to feel very anxious, not sleeping, are feeling irritable, or any combination of these symptoms, you may be have prenatal depression. This can be serious and if untreated, increases your risk of depression postpartum. Speak to your doctor or midwife.

ASK A DOCTOR

I think I may have food poisoning. Will this harm my baby? Some food-borne illnesses, such as salmonella, campylobacter, and E. coli will not directly harm your baby but can make you very ill, causing profuse vomiting and diarrhea that could lead to extreme dehydration. It's important to keep your fluid intake up both to flush out the offending pathogens, and to ensure you're sufficiently hydrated. If the vomiting is so serious that you can't keep any fluid down, contact your doctor's office as you may need IV fluids for rehydration. Infection with listeria bacteria is the most serious type of food poisoning since it may cause a miscarriage or premature labor. It is, therefore, essential to contact your doctor's office if you believe that you've eaten food that is contaminated (see [Dietary precautions](#)), so that the relevant checkup can be done and treatment given, if necessary.

Always be especially careful when you are choosing food and follow hygiene rules when preparing it. Avoid eating foods that are commonly associated with [food poisoning](#).

FOCUS ON TWINS
